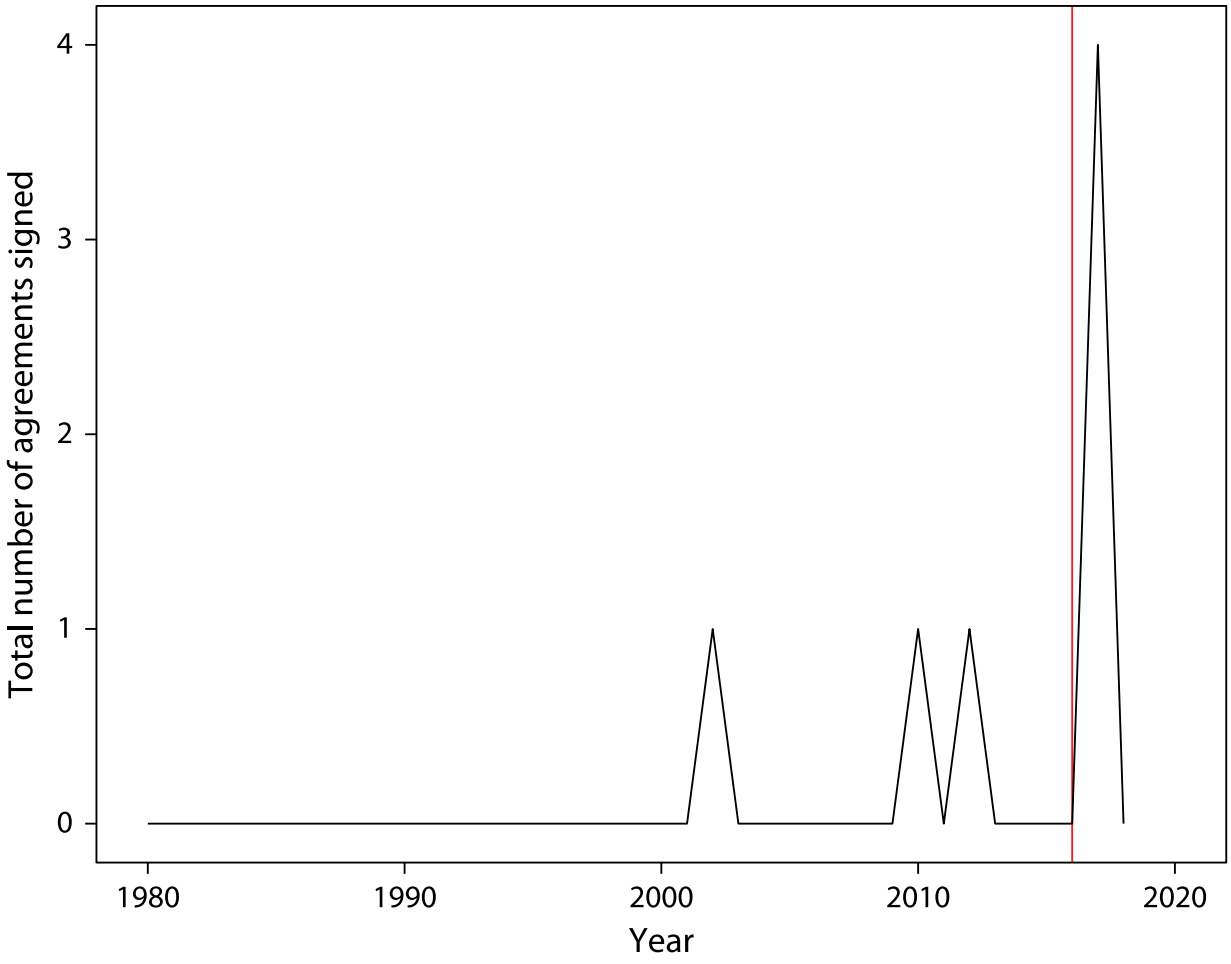


FIGURE 4.5. Number of information-sharing agreements signed by US-led development IOs with Arab IOs, 1980–2018. The vertical line demarcates 2016 (the year of Trump's election).

To investigate the underlying mechanism, we turned to data on information suppression by the Trump administration, particularly in the domains of public health and climate change—critical areas for development IOs. The Silencing Science Tracker documents numerous instances of restricted scientific research, altered publications, and budget cuts to research agencies.[18] As shown in figure 4.6, suppression events escalated sharply after Trump assumed office in 2017, with categories like "Bias," "Budget Cuts," and "Research Hindrance" dominating the landscape (figure 4.7).